

WHO Pregnancy Nutrition and Supplement Guidelines:

1. Iron and Folic Acid Supplementation:

WHO recommends daily oral iron and folic acid supplementation with 30 mg to 60 mg of elemental iron and 400 micrograms (0.4 mg) of folic acid for pregnant women to prevent maternal anaemia, puerperal sepsis, low birth weight, and preterm birth.

Pairs iron-rich foods with vitamin C (like citrus fruits and bell peppers) to boost absorption significantly. Avoid tea and coffee during meals as they contain tannins that inhibit iron absorption.

2. Calcium Supplementation:

In populations with low dietary calcium intake, daily calcium supplementation (1.5g to 2.0g of elemental calcium) is recommended for pregnant women to reduce the risk of pre-eclampsia.

3. Dietary Energy and Protein Intake:

Healthy pregnant women should focus on nutrient-dense foods: lean proteins (chicken, fish, eggs, beans, lentils), whole grains (oats, brown rice, whole-wheat bread), and plenty of colorful fruits and vegetables. Avoid processed sugars and raw, unpasteurized dairy or undercooked meats.

4. Caffeine Limits:

For pregnant women with high daily caffeine intake (more than 300 mg per day), WHO recommends lowering daily caffeine intake to under 200 mg per day to reduce the risk of pregnancy loss and low birth weight. One cup of standard brewed coffee contains roughly 95 mg of caffeine.